

Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	

1. BACKGROUND

- 1 All wood poles have the potential to bleed creosote and there are many factors that can affect the likelihood of a pole bleeding.

Poles can change state between bleeding and not bleeding with only small changes in temperature or exposure to direct sunlight. During the winter months it is very difficult to identify bleeding poles. However, during the warmer months, bleeding poles begin to reveal themselves.

It is critical that this window of opportunity is used to minimise the possibility of bleeding poles being despatched to our customers.

2. RATIONALE

- 1 The aim of this module is to ensure that bleeding poles:
- Are identified at an appropriate stage in the process
 - Are removed from the register of available stock
 - Are segregated to prevent inadvertent delivery
 - Are remediated via immersion in hot creosote (wash charge)
- 2 This Module is supported by QTG58 (Collection and Replacement Defective Poles) and QTG40 (Goods Returned).

3. PROCESS

- 1 If you see poles that are bleeding, you must:
- a) Securely staple a red label to the pole butt, if you have any with you.
 - b) Bring them to the attention of the person in charge straight away, and;
 - c) Not assume that someone else has already reported them.

This includes poles that may have already been loaded onto a trailer and may be leaving the yard (you will not be creating difficulties by doing this – the driver will simply bring the poles back to be placed on a wash charge).

ALL STAFF

Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	

2

If you are loading poles, you must:

- a) Remain vigilant - not just for bleeding poles but also for poles that have an appearance that indicates that they are likely to bleed.
- b) If you are unsure of the surface features that indicate a pole that is likely to bleed, ask for additional training or guidance until you are happy that you can spot these poles easily.

3

Where you identify poles that are bleeding or likely to bleed, you must:

- a) Not load the poles.
- b) Record the pole size, drawing and location on the Internal Stock Transfer Form.
- c) Securely staple a red label to the pole **there and then**. *If you do not then it is likely that that same pole will be loaded on a cooler day when the surface looks fine (obviously it will then go on to bleed on a warmer day).*
- d) Scan the Internal Stock Transfer Form to the stock controller so that the affected poles can be removed from the list of available stock.
- e) Where the pole is accessible, remove the pole from the stock bay and place it in a designated bleeding pole bay, ready for remedial treatment.

LOADER

4

If you are delivering poles, you must:

- a) Remain vigilant - not just for bleeding poles but also for poles that have an appearance that indicates that they are likely to bleed.
- b) If you are unsure of the surface features that indicate a pole that is likely to bleed, ask for additional training or guidance until you are happy that you can spot these poles easily.

5

If you identify a bleeding or potentially bleeding pole on your load, you must:

- a) Apply a red label **immediately**. *This is important because a bleeding pole can re-absorb the creosote and appear to not be bleeding with only a very small reduction in temperature. The wind generated during the journey can cool the pole surface, so that a pole that is bleeding when you set off may not be bleeding when you arrive at your destination and you will not know which pole you were supposed to be bringing back with you.*

DELIVERY DRIVER

Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	

6

b) Not deliver it.

c) Bring it back with you when you return to the depot.

Whilst you are at the customer's site, you must:

a) Remain vigilant for bleeding poles and bring them back with you where possible.

b) If the poles are inaccessible for removal, securely staple a red label on them so that they are not used and can be put aside for when you are next on site.

c) Record the sizes, drawings and locations of the affected poles.

d) Explain what you have done to the person in charge of the site.

e) Pass details of the pole sizes, drawings and locations to the transport department, so that suitable replacements can be prepared if necessary.

f) When you are removing bleeding poles from a customer site, you must also securely staple a yellow label (bearing the number of the relevant NCR, where available) onto each pole.

Note1: QTG58 contains more detail regarding the requirements for collecting defective poles and QTG40 contains more detail regarding the process to be followed for returning goods (GRN etc.)

Note2: You must maintain a good stock of red labels and staples on your vehicle at all times.

DELIVERY DRIVER

Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	

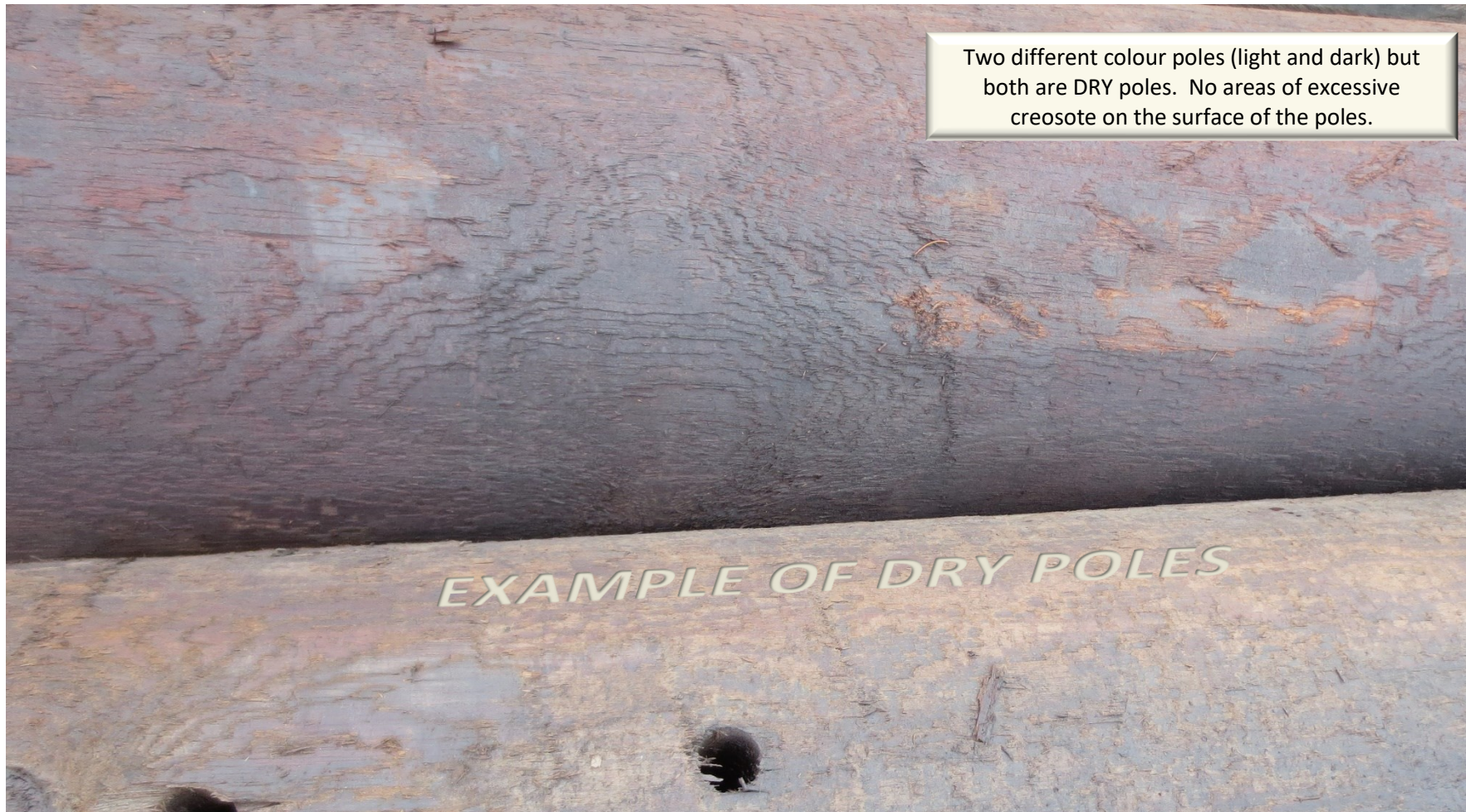
4. GLOVE TEST

- 1 A glove test can assist in determining the current bleed status of poles. However you must also assess the 'bleed propensity' of the pole (the likelihood that the pole will bleed in the future, even though it is not bleeding at present).
- 2 The glove test is conducted as follows:
 - a) Wearing a light coloured cotton glove or cloth (with a nitrile glove beneath it to protect your skin), place your hand on the pole.
 - b) Remove your hand and check the result against the table below.

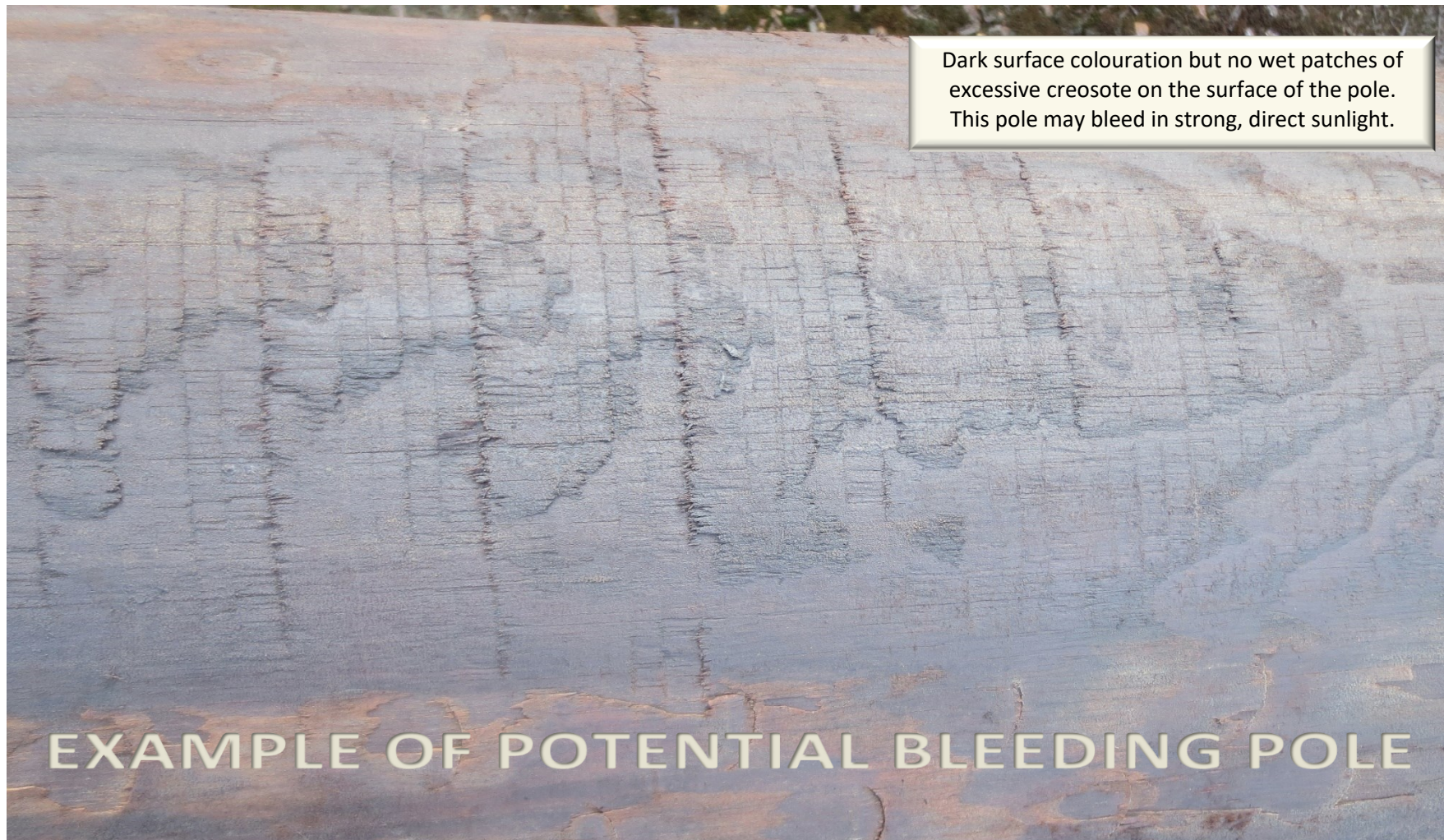
Category	Result of Test	Comments	Action
A	Dry, no creosote on glove/cloth	Any part of the pole .	Accept
B	Dry, no creosote on glove/cloth	Any part of the pole except the knots. Wet areas of creosote around knots are acceptable.	Accept
C	Dry, no creosote on glove/cloths	Any part of the pole Up to 40% of pole surface may be covered in dried solidified creosote residue (tar).	Accept
D	Dry, no creosote on glove/cloths	Any part of the pole Over 40% of pole surface is covered in dried solidified creosote residue (tar).	Reject
E	Wet, creosote soaked into glove/cloth	Any part of the pole except the knots. Definite thin film of creosote and possibly in patches or strips	Reject
F	Wet, creosote soaked into glove/cloth	Any part of the pole except the knots. Whole pole has a thin layer of creosote over the entire surface area	Reject
G	Wet, creosote soaked into glove/cloth	Any part of the pole except the knots. Thick wet tar in strips or patches.	Reject

Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4 Revision Date: Jun 2023	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revised By: D. Losty	

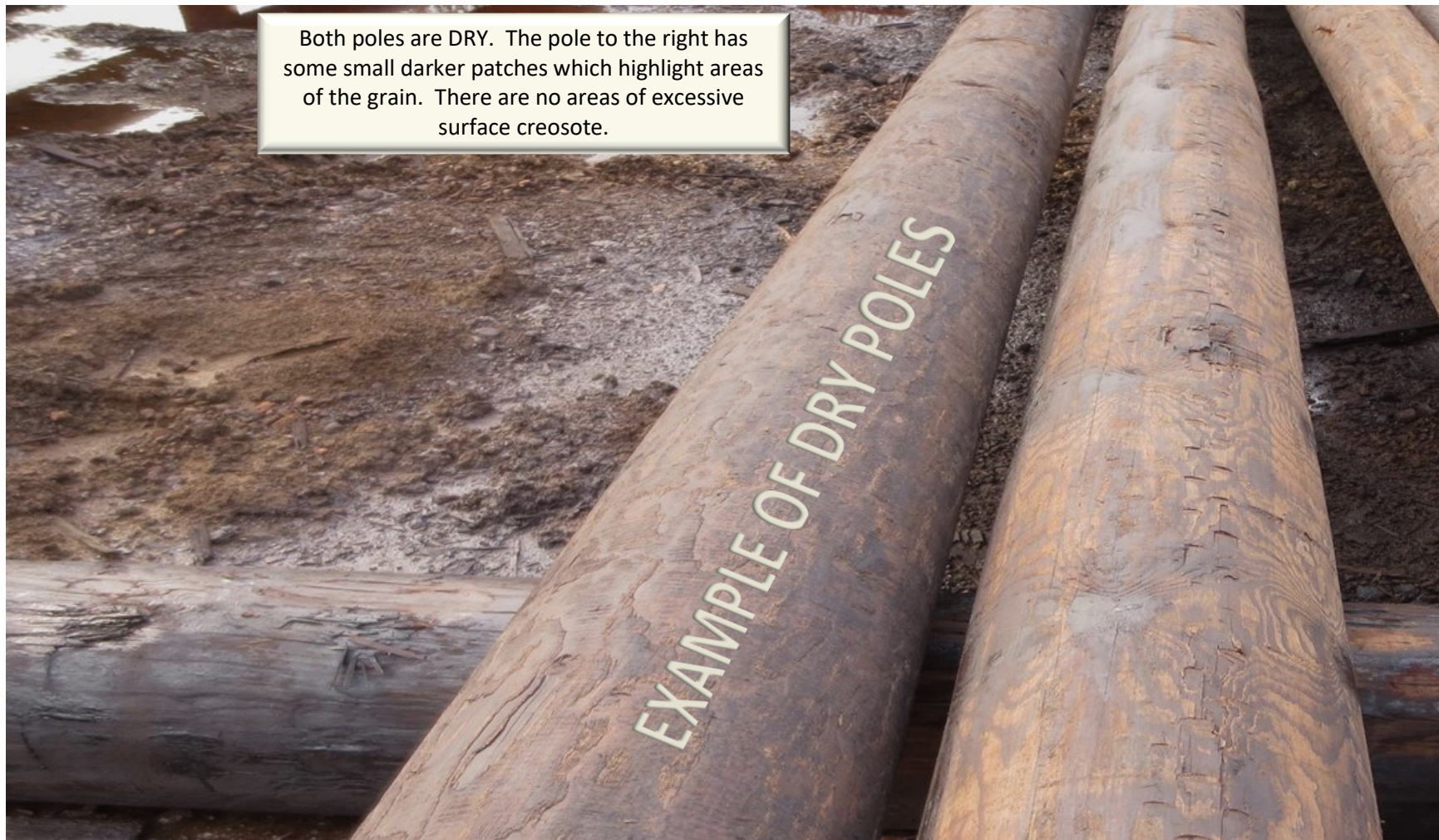
5. BLEEDING SCALE



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	

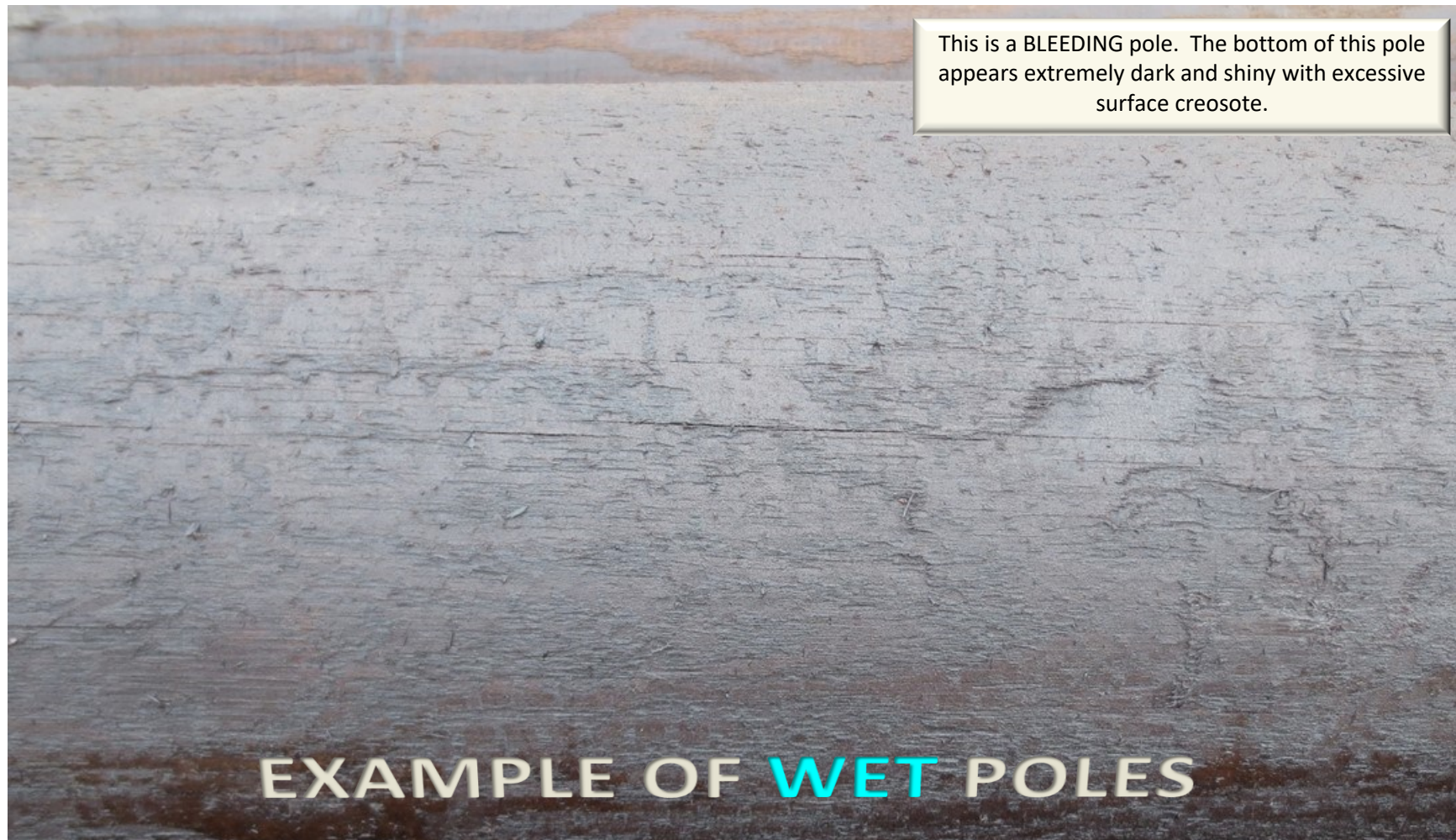
This is a BLEEDING pole. Large areas of the pole have excessive creosote on the surface with a clearly wet and shiny appearance.



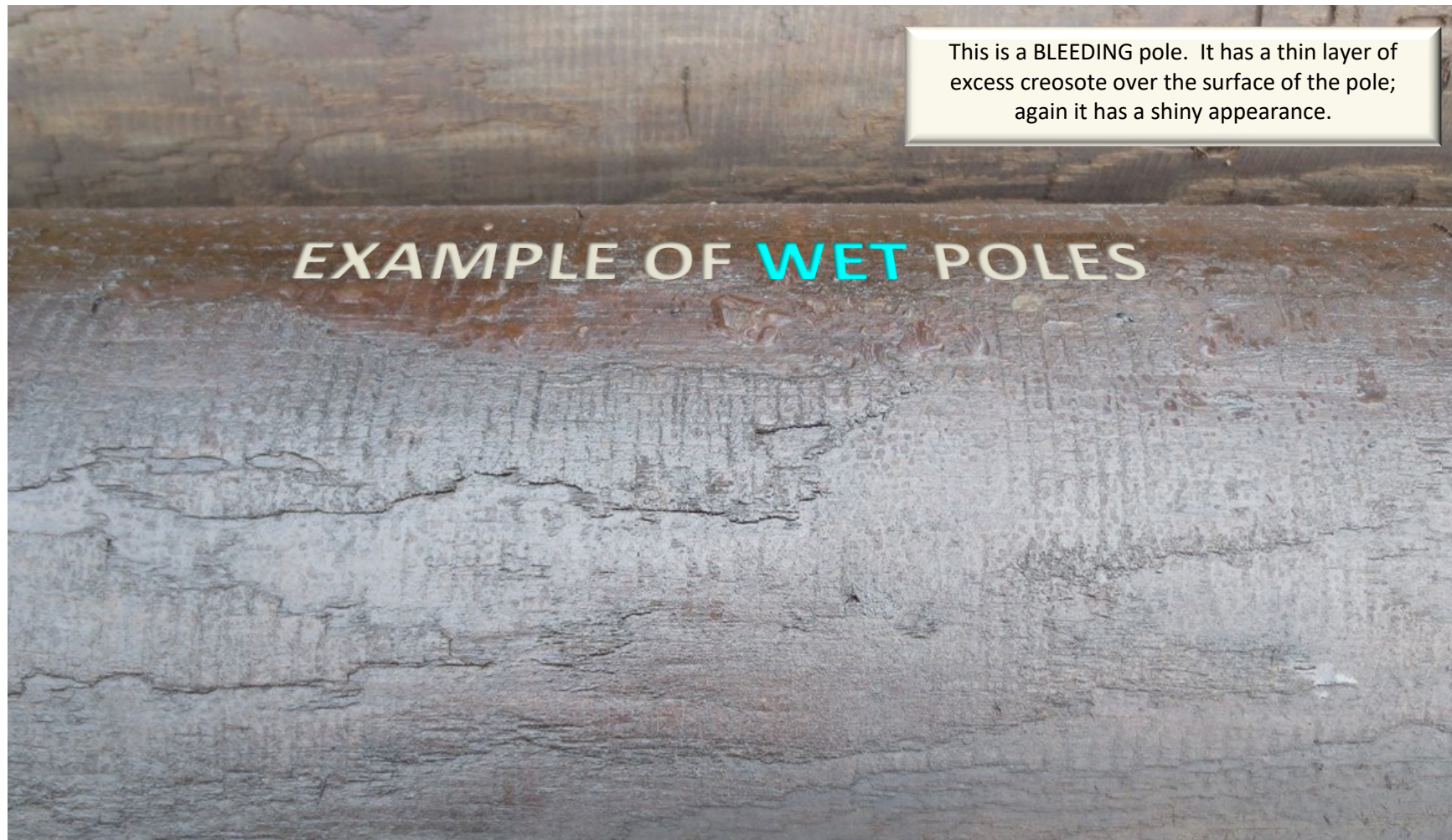
Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	



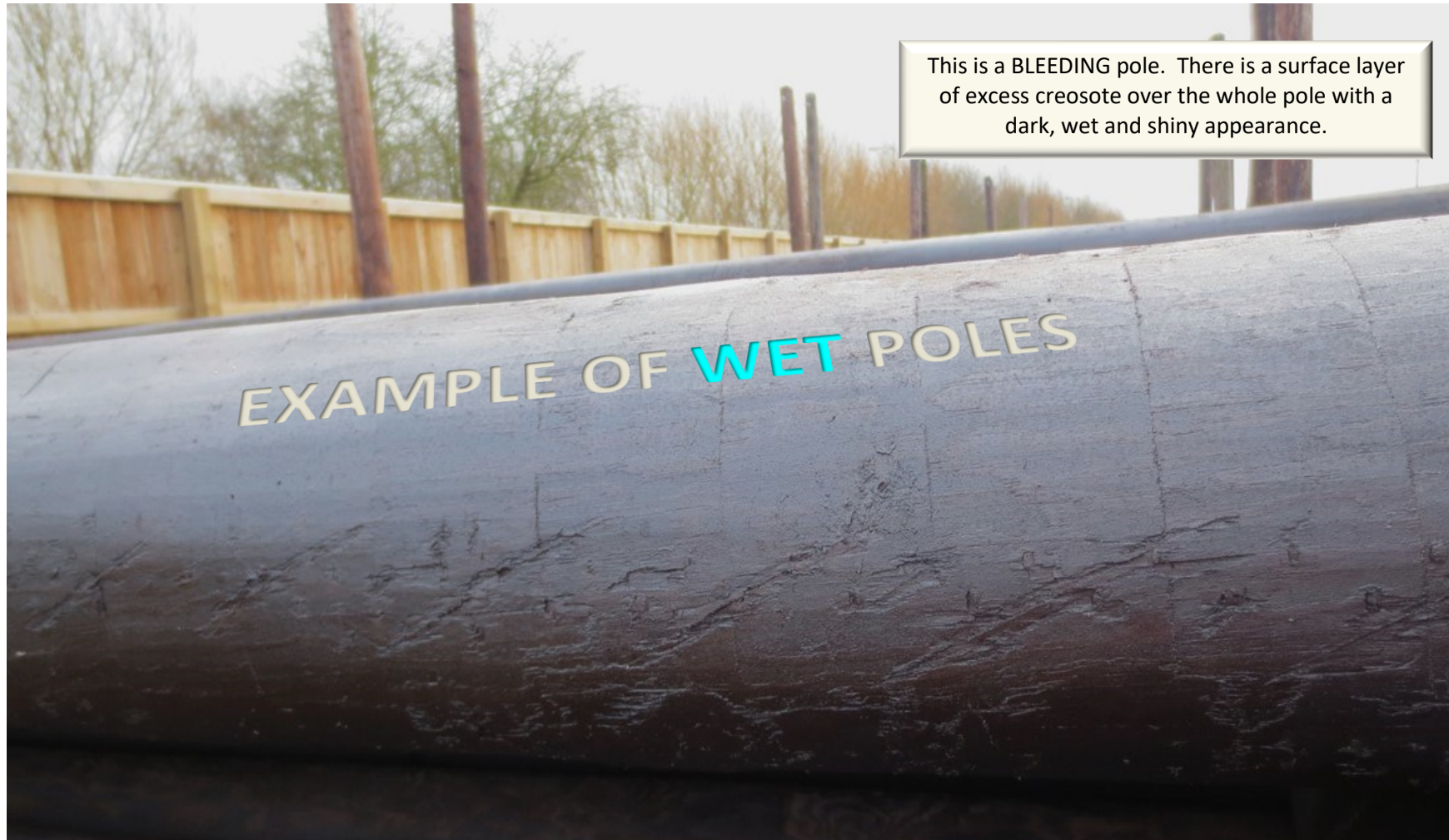
Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	



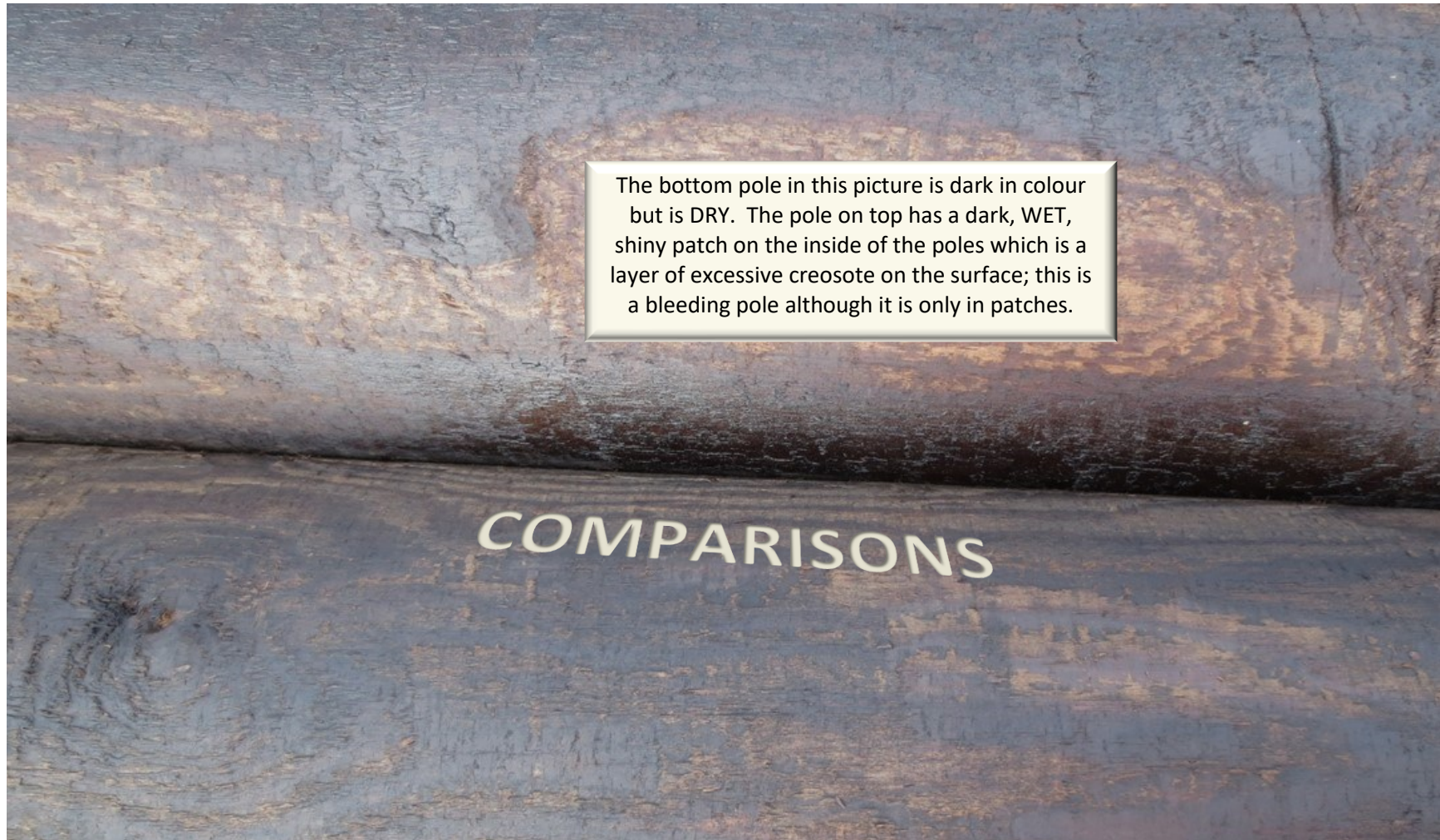
Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	Revision Date: Jun 2023
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revised By: D. Losty	



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4 Revision Date: Jun 2023	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revised By: D. Losty	



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	



Ref no:	Module 6	Calders & Grandidge	
Compiled By: D. Losty	Bleeding Poles	Revision 4	
Effective Date: Mar 2020		Revision Date: Jun 2023	
		Revised By: D. Losty	

Documents Replaced by this Module

Document Ref.	Document Title
QTG24	Bleeding Scale

Updates

Date	Amendment	By
1-3-20	Original Document	DL
13-7-21	Details of testing locations added at section 2.	DL
7-10-21	Glove Test process added.	DL
26-6-23	Next review date amended following review.	DL

Next Review 2024 – unless otherwise required